Tideline

Newsletter of the Marrowby Institute for Coastal Research · Issue 14 · Autumn 2026

New tide gauge network goes live

Six new tide gauges along the Marrowby estuary began reporting in real time on 2 September. The gauges replace a network of float recorders that had been read by hand once a week since 1987. Readings are now published every five minutes and archived for public use.

The project was led by the instrumentation group, who spent most of the summer installing stilling wells at harbour walls and slipways. Two sites needed new concrete plinths after the spring storms undermined the old ones. Calibration against a portable reference gauge showed agreement within four millimetres at every site.

> *Readings are now published every five minutes.*

Data users should note that the station codes have changed. A conversion table is available from the data office on request.

Field season in numbers

The summer field programme was the busiest since the institute opened.

Activity	2025	2026
Survey days at sea	41	58
Sediment cores taken	126	173
Volunteer hours	910	1,240
Seal counts completed	12	15

Most of the increase came from the new survey launch, which can work in water too shallow for the old vessel. Volunteers from the Easthaven sailing club logged more than a third of all volunteer hours.

Archive digitisation reaches 1950

The archive team has now scanned every survey sheet held by the institute from 1950 to the present. Each sheet is stored as a high-resolution image together with a short catalogue record.

Older material, including the hand-drawn charts of the 1930s, needs conservation before it can be handled. A specialist paper conservator will visit in the new year to assess the worst affected volumes. Until then, researchers can view these charts only by appointment.

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Diary dates

- 6 Nov: open lecture, "Saltmarsh carbon"
- 20 Nov: volunteer training day
- 4 Dec: winter seal count
- 11 Dec: library closes for the holidays

Contact

Communications office
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Grants awarded this term

Four new research grants were confirmed between June and September. Together they fund eleven posts for at least two years.

Project	Lead	Funder	Award (GBP)	Duration
Saltmarsh carbon burial across three estuaries	Dr Ines Halloran	Coastal Futures Trust	412,000	36 months
Microplastics in mussel beds	Dr Kofi Mensah-Bright	North Sea Research Fund	188,500	24 months
Storm surge forecasting for small harbours	Prof. Alma Rustad	Regional Resilience Board	265,000	30 months
Citizen seal monitoring	Tom Ashdown	Marrowby Community Lottery	24,800	12 months

How to contribute

The newsletter welcomes short articles from staff, students and volunteers.

1. Send a draft of no more than 400 words to the communications office.
2. Attach photographs as separate files:
   a. at least 1,600 pixels wide;
   b. with the photographer named in the file name.
3. Copy for the winter issue closes on 14 November.

Staff news

Dr Petra Lindqvist joins the sediment group as a postdoctoral researcher from 1 November. She comes from a fjord monitoring programme and will lead the new coring work.

After nineteen years in the workshop, Gerald Pyke retires at the end of October. Many of the instruments now in the field were built or rebuilt by his hands. A farewell tea will be held in the common room on his last Friday.

Autumn seminar series

Date	Speaker	Title
13 Nov	Dr Ines Halloran	How much carbon does a saltmarsh really keep?
27 Nov	Wen Zhao	Listening to harbour seals with low-cost hydrophones
11 Dec	Prof. Alma Rustad	Forecasting surge at the scale of a single harbour

Seminars start at 16:00 in the Harbour Room and are followed by tea. Remote attendance links are sent to the mailing list on the morning of each talk.